WORKSHOP HANDOUT

Decentralized curation

Putting self-interest to work for the public good.

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026, 14:00 to 15:20

Who judges what matters?

Decentralized Curation uses human judgment, incentives and challenges to build shared assessments under a chosen policy. Those assessments can guide what we read, reuse or reward. **Here we apply the framework to public-goods funding.**

The funding application

1. **Set the policy.** Define what matters and pay for curation. Funding for beneficiaries can arrive later.
2. **Nominate work.** Anyone can name a beneficiary, publish claims and evidence, and put down a deposit. Claims can enter before being fact-checked.
3. **Judge relevance.** People lock tokens they risk losing to enter the jury lottery. Selected jurors score independently under the policy.
4. **Keep scores current.** Renew scores periodically. Anyone can fund an objection; competing funded proposals trigger an appeal with a larger jury.
5. **Publish allocation shares.** Curated weights determine how available or later funding is divided.
6. **Challenge facts at any time.** Anyone can challenge an active nomination's claims. An external arbitrator decides. False or untestable claims cost the nomination its deposit and future funding. Past earnings are kept; a new nomination is allowed.

Fund curation. Distribute later.

A	B	C
0.50	0.30	0.20
50%	30%	20%

0.50 + 0.30 + 0.20 = 1.00

Illustrative shares, not measured fractions of public benefit. Any later distribution budget can follow them. No positive weights means no allocation.

One example: research infrastructure

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Consider 1	Consider 2	Consider 3
how many rely	role in research	other options

0.00	not infrastructure
0.25	matters to one field
0.50	relied on in several fields
0.75	widely relied on
1.00	critical across research

Each pool chooses its own policy. Policy context and attribution.

Today: try relevance scoring

1 Read the policy	2 Score alone
3 Seal your score	4 Reveal together

An equal-seat points game about relevance scoring. Full jury selection, accuracy disputes, appeals and funding are outside this exercise.

Use an alias or observe. Revealed scores and standings are public; role-play may be assigned. Keep score proofs private; ask before photos. The host wipes results afterward.

What did the incentives reward?

Evidence or simply agreement? Agreement proves neither truth nor public benefit. Reliable judgment and resistance to collusion still need testing.

Try, read, stay in touch

The room

Published preprint

Mailing list

Room: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Join: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/join/

Published preprint, version 1.2.0: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23313625.

Release source · Public mechanism and evidence limits. Later hardening is outside this archived release.

Sponsored by Octant

Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer.

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